The parsha starts off וַיְדַבֵּר מֹשֶׁה אֶל רָאשֵׁי הַמַּטּוֹת לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר זֶה הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה ה׳. This פסוק is different from most of the other דברות that משה רבינו was given, in two significant ways. Usually it's וידבר משה or וידבר ה׳ אל משה לאמר or וידבר משה אל בני ישראל. But here, he's talking to the ראשי המטות, which is very unusual. The second aspect is זֶה הַדָּבָר, which is a חשובה לשון as רש"י points out. משה רבינו uses the לשון of זֶה הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה ה׳, while the other נביאים said כה אמר ה׳ to tell you that Moshe's level of נבואה was on a significantly higher מדרגה. But if we think about it for a second, that's not the usual syntax of the פסוקים elsewhere in the Torah. What would have made more sense to stay consistent with other פסוקים? It should have said: וידבר משה אל ראשי המטות לבני ישראל, זה הדבר אשר צוה השם לאמר. That's the usual format. But here, the לֵאמֹר comes before זֶה הַדָּבָר. What is that telling us?

The אזנים לתורה, whose יארצייט was this past week, Rav Zalman Sorotzkin זכותו יגן עלינו, has a detailed and important lesson to be taught about the significance of the human being, and how our ability to speak makes us the pinnacle and highlight of מעשה בראשית. He explains that the order is different from the norm so you can read it: לֵאמֹר - to say, זֶה הַדָּבָר. In other words, the זֶה הַדָּבָר is part of what you have to say. That's why the לֵאמֹר comes before it. לֵאמֹר, you have to say, זֶה הַדָּבָר. The ראשי המטות have to tell בני ישראל not only the דינים of נדרים but, זֶה הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה ה׳. You have to know all the הלכות of נדרים, but that's because this is זה הדבר. Exactly in the same way that you know that eating שקצים ורמשים, נבילות וטריפות, every other מצוה in the Torah that were given as a ציווי השם, in exactly the same way, when you make a נדר, you have to follow all of the rules that הקדוש ברוך הוא gave you for the הלכות of נדר, קונם, the whole מסכתא of נדרים.

That's why it says זה הדבר by נדרים. What is it telling you? This is חשוב. When you talk, when you open your mouth, you have to remember this is the power that Hashem gave you. Watch how you talk. The דיבור of an אדם can change everything. The דיבור of an אדם, your power of speech, can take something that's מותר and make it אסור. The Torah emphasizes this because it's so hard for us to understand that. "What do you mean? We know a lot of חוקים, but my simple speech can say that something which previously was מותר is now אסור?" That is an astounding חידוש.

This piece of מאכל was totally permitted, but if I say קונם עלי, then it becomes אסור to me. What does that mean? A בשר חזיר can be מזיק a person's נשמה. But if someone makes a נדר and says that this thing, which was previously מותר, is now אסור to me, it's a הזיק to his נשמה in exactly the same way as חזיר would be. It creates טמטום הלב.

Why did this ענין have to be said to the ראשי המטות? What's the lesson to be learned from that? Hashem in his kindness wanted to assist us in understanding how it is possible that a נדר can cause that change. The example the Torah utilizes is the נשיאים, who became elevated because בני ישראל bestowed the title of נשיא on them. Through their power of speech, בני ישראל took regular people and elevated them to the status of a נשיא. The מדרש רבה says this was familiar to בני ישראל, as they had נשיאים in מצרים.

That was זה הדבר: that דיבור has the ability to be מקדש. If you want to take this דומם and you want to be מקדש it to the בדק הבית, it now has קדושה. Why? Because you said so. If you harvest your field, take off a שטיקל grain and say "This is תרומה," it's now תרומה. If a זר eats that, he's חייב כרת. So you can take a דומם and make it קדוש. You can take a צומח and make it קדוש. You can take an animal and say הרי זו עולה, it is now an עולה. If you say הרי זו שלמים, it's a שלמים. We have the ability to change the טבע of the world from the lowest to the highest. That is the power of דיבור. So let us be a little more respectful of the power of our tongue.

https://youtu.be/Z-NAoX43Ylk